

Introduction to Cryptocurrency

Understanding basic concepts of peer-peer value exchange, why it's important and how to get started



HOW DO I KNOW IF ITS A SCAM?

Steer clear of exchanges until
you've done your research and
hold most elsewhere.

Anyone gotten swindled?

Blackmail

Blackmail attempts in which strangers threaten you in exchange for bitcoin as a means of extortion. Commonly by email, where-in the sender transmits a message claiming that he/she has hacked into your computer and is operating it via remote desktop protocol (RDP).

The sender will often say it accessed webcam/personal info and provides two options - send bitcoin to suppress the material, or send nothing and see the content sent to your email contacts and spread across your social networks. Scammers use stolen email lists and other leaked user information to run this scheme across thousands of people en masse.

Fake Exchanges

As bitcoin has become more popular, more people have sought to acquire it. Unfortunately, nefarious people have taken advantage of this and have been known to set up fake bitcoin exchanges. These fake exchanges may trick users by offering extremely competitive market prices that lull them into thinking they're getting a steal, with quick and easy access to some cheap bitcoin. Be sure to use a reputable exchange when buying or selling bitcoin.

Free Giveaways

Due to the viral nature of how information spreads across on the internet, scammers seek to take advantage of people by offering free giveaways of bitcoin or other digital currencies in exchange for sending a small amount to register, or by providing some personal information. When you see this on a website or social network, it's best to immediately report the content as fraudulent, so that others don't fall victim.

Impersonation

Unfortunately it's very easy for con-artists to create social media accounts and impersonate people. Often times they lie in wait, until the person they're trying to impersonate publishes content. The impersonator then replies to it with a follow-up message or call to action - like a free giveaway - using an account that looks almost identical to the original poster or author. This makes it seem like the original person is saying it. Alternatively, impersonators may also try to use these same fake accounts to trick others via private or direct message into taking some kind of action in an attempt to defraud or compromise. Never participate in free giveaways, and if you receive an odd request via someone in your network, it's best to double check to confirm the authenticity via multiple mediums of communication.

Malware

Hackers have become very creative at finding ways to steal from people. When sending bitcoin, always be sure to double or triple check the address you're sending to. Some malware programs, once installed, will change bitcoin addresses when they're pasted from a user's clipboard, so that all of the bitcoin unknowingly gets sent to the hacker's address instead. Since there is little chance of reversing a bitcoin transaction once it's confirmed by the network, noticing this after the fact means it's too late and most likely can't be recovered. It's a good idea to be super-cautious about what programs you allow to have administrator access on your devices. An up-to-date, reputable virus scanner can also help but is not foolproof.

Meeting in Person

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Money Transfer Fraud

Do not reply to emails or inbound communications from strangers telling you they need help moving some money, whereafter in exchange for your services, you'll get a portion of the funds.

Phishing Emails

Beware of emails purported to be from services you use soliciting you for action, such as resetting your password, or clicking through to provide some sort of interaction with regard to your account. It can be very difficult to spot the difference in a fake email that's trying to entice you to compromise your account, and a legitimate one sent on behalf of a product or service that you use. When in doubt, considering triple-checking the authenticity of the communication by forwarding it to the company, using the contact email address on their website, calling them on the telephone, and/or reaching out to them via their official social media accounts.

Phishing Websites

Phishing websites often go hand-in-hand with phishing emails. Phishing emails can link to a replica website designed to steal login credentials or prompt one to install malware. Do not install software or log in to a website unless you are 100% sure it isn't a fake one. Phishing websites may also appear as sponsored results on search engines or in app marketplaces used by mobile devices. Be wary that you aren't downloading a fake app or clicking a sponsored link to a fake website.

Ponzi and Pyramid Schemes

Do not participate in offerings where one or more people offer you a guaranteed return in exchange for an upfront deposit. This is known as a ponzi scheme, where-in future depositors' principals are used to pay previous investors. The end result is usually a lot of people losing a lot of money.

A pyramid scheme promises returns to participants based on the number of people they invite to join. This enables the scheme to grow virally and rapidly, however, it most often doesn't result in any kind of meaningful return. Never invite your personal network under the sole goal of accumulating rewards or returns from a product or service, and do not contribute your own capital at the behest of others to accelerate the process.

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Pump and Dump

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Ransomware

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What today is not about....

Getting rich with cryptocurrency. Long term benefit is having an asset that can't be taken.

Trading and becoming an expert on exchanges. This is about basic fundamentals of understanding it's use and getting started.

This is in no way financial advice. It is rather alerting you to the practical applications of peer-peer exchange.

The 5 W's of Cryptocurrency

The 5 W's- What, Who/When, Where, Why, How

Today we discuss the basics of cryptocurrency so you can better understand the digital future we face globally.

My journey in crypto began in 2014 and I've had my share of learning experiences. I am not an expert by any means, but rather want to share some best practices.

Crypto is a tool

Store of value
Means of exchange
Unit of account



WHAT is cryptocurrency?

It is a string of letters and numbers that cannot be counterfeited. Like a serial number on cash essentially.

These secret codes can be exchanged with another person through a decentralized ledger.

Miners compete to verify this ledger and create new coins, in essence working together to keep the books up to date and verified; cutting out the govnt/banks from centralizing our value exchange.

Miners also bring new money into existence, some coins are limited and some are limitless.

WHAT is are exchanges and privacy coins?

Privacy coins—ARRR, Monero, Ghost?

Exchanges— Coinbase, Bittru, Wealthsimple—Who has been through the process?

Exchanges do KYC and more regulations will follow.

You must claim earnings when you bring it back to fiat or buy gold/silver.

We don't own crypto—we have a list of numbers to access a code on the blockchain.

WHO came up with it?

Thirteen years ago a person or group using the name Satoshi Nakamoto released a paper describing a new software system called bitcoin.

Nobody knows who this entity was, but this gift of technology has taken the shackles off humanity.

The bigger hurdle is to convince people they don't need the shackles.

8.95 Trillion

US Debt **BETTER STAT

A devaluing dollar supports new need for CBDC, mass adoption of decentralized currency will combat this.

I'm not a tech person and see value in more than crypto, however our best chance against incoming inflation is to understand our options.

WHY should I start using it?

Understanding how it works and being comfortable will open up options during this digital transformation

Understanding decentralization will be tool to combatting CBDC

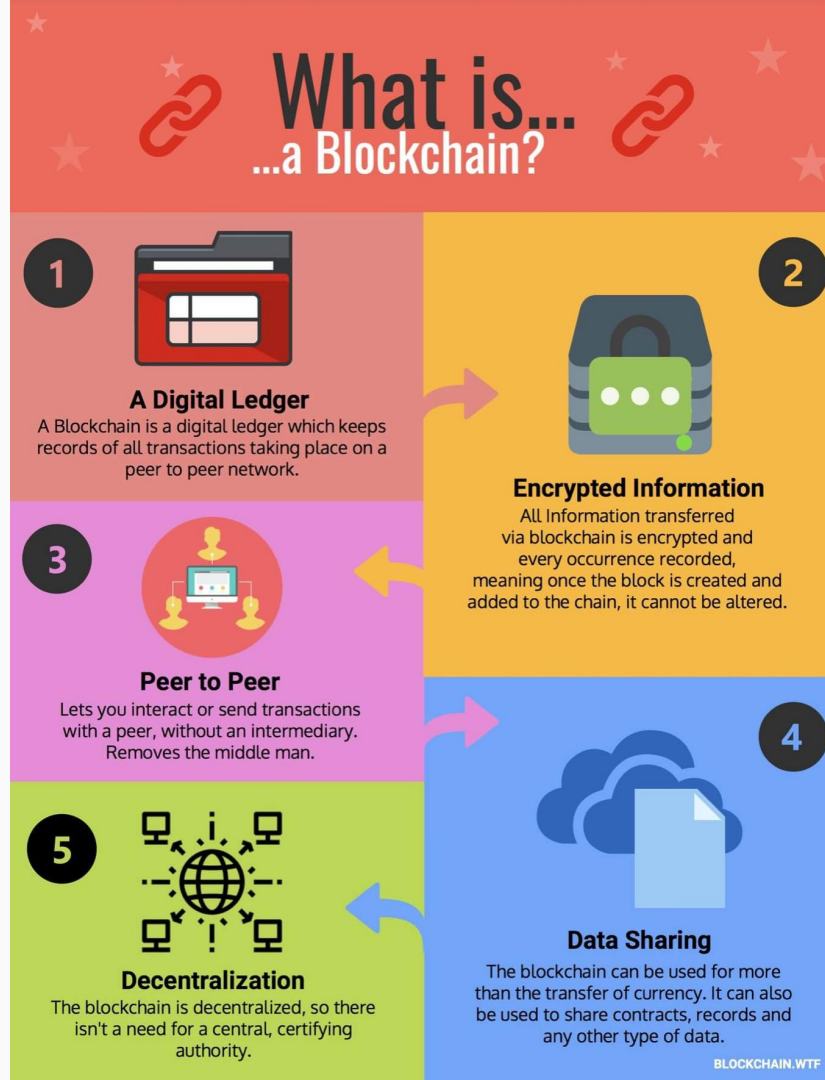
It can hedge against inflation

...

REMEMBER COOL CASH? Visual

WHERE does it exist?

The blockchain



HOW do I get started safely?

Avoiding scams (and even exchanges—for now)

Use a simple onboard into a private wallet— hardware &/or software

Keep your eggs in many baskets

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How to get money onto the blockchain?

Shakepay as an onboard—

EMT

AVOID EXCHANGES

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UNFORTUNATELY—WOULD BE A WAY
TO AVOID BANKS ENTIRELY.

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SOFTWARE VS HARDWARE

SOFTWARE

HARDWARE

Keep your eggs in many baskets

Advantages and disadvantages

crypto
vs
gold/silver
vs
assets/commodities

Convenient and portable but
dependent on electricity.

Adoption is a battle but it's a sound
means of exchange for
self-sufficient communities.

More difficult to confiscate but
likely to be vilified.

“Our fear of technology is really a fear of empowerment. We now have the ability to design the reality we live in and we have to step up to that occasion.”

- Douglas Rushkoff
Author of Life inc., influential thinker

Not your keys;
Not your crypto.

Now let's watch some clips to hammer it in

Contact us:

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Parrsjars.ca

Setting up a hardware wallet